



Examination Guidance Booklet

Please read the whole of the guidance booklet. Guidance on accessing and submitting your examination paper, examinable material, feedback on examination scripts, results and grading and examination preparation can all be found in this booklet.

Guidance for answering your Online MCQs for Section A

1. Go to the link in the Final Assessment Section titled 'Access to Examination and Portal Submission'. This will take you through to the page where you will be able to start your examination.
2. Once open, select 'view exam'
3. Instructions for both Part A and B will be available to read through along with the Terms and Acceptance which you will need to agree to before starting the exam.
4. Upon starting the exam, Section A instructions will show, read through, then select start section and submit to start exam
5. Answer all MCQ questions by selecting the answer you think is correct.
6. Once completed make sure all questions have been answered before selecting 'Continue to submit section'.
7. Once the MCQs are submitted, section A will be complete, and you will not be able to return to that section to edit or answer any further questions within that section.

Guidance for submitting examination answers via the Examination Submission Portal for Section B

1. Once Section A is completed Section B instructions will show. Once read, select start section and submit to start this section.
2. Section B provides the question paper and answer booklet for downloading. You can now start answering Section B questions in your answer booklet.
3. Your assessment can be submitted as a Word document or PDF file. You should enter your Customer Contact Number for the submission title.
4. Once completed, go to the link in the Final Assessment Section titled 'Access to Examination and Portal Submission'. This will take you through to the page where you will see the Upload File button on the right-hand side of your screen.
5. Select 'Upload File' button.
6. Upload your assessment either via the add icon or drag and drop to add the file which can be found on the left-hand side of the screen– only one file can be selected at a time.
7. Please submit one document only.
8. The file that you have uploaded will be visible in the upload box on the left-hand side – you can check if the name of the document is correct to ensure you have selected the right document to submit.
9. Select 'Submit Answer' on the bottom right of the screen. Make sure you only select 'Submit Answer' when you are happy the correct document is uploaded. Upon selecting the submit button you will be asked a further two times to confirm you wish to continue with submitting

A video can be found on your online learning platform in the Assessment Guidance section called 'How to access your exam'.

The format of your examination is illustrated by the Specimen Assessments provided on the online learning platform; the link can be found in the Assessment Preparation Section which is titled 'Access to

specimen assessments' - this will take you through to the page where you can access the examples. Please review these carefully ahead of the examination.

Examinable material

The entire syllabus is examinable and examination questions may be set on material contained in any of the course materials provided to you.

Examination questions will not be set on law that is less than six months old.

You will not be penalised for basing your answer on law that is out of date if it is presented as the current position in the course material.

Equally, you will not be penalised for referring to new legislation not covered in the course material in your examination answers.

If you have any queries in relation to this, please contact us at cltinternational@centlaw.com.

Feedback on examination scripts

Although personalised feedback is not a feature of the course, if you are struggling to understand where you may have missed available marks, please contact us and we will be able to provide a breakdown of the marks allocated to each question. This service is not available to students who have passed their exam. The request must be received within **four weeks** of the release of the result and is free of charge. Candidates' examination scripts will not be returned under any circumstances.

Please note that for students who are unsuccessful in their examination attempt, we do not offer remarks or arrange for the examiner to look at your script again. All scripts go through a stringent marking and review process before results are released. We do have an appeal process, but please note that any application for appeal must be based on one of the three stipulated appeal grounds, information on which can be found in the Appeals Policy located in the Policy Hub on the home page. Appeals will not be accepted on the grounds of dissatisfaction with your mark.

Clerical check of result

A clerical check of the mark awarded can be carried out on request. This involves a check of all procedures leading to the issue of the result, including a review of the candidate's answer script to ensure the result issued is accurate and reflects the marks awarded by the examiner on the script.

If there were mitigating circumstances, there will be a check that these were taken into consideration. The candidate will not receive any additional feedback on their performance as part of the check.

The request must be received within four weeks of the release of the result and is free of charge.

Results

Results are released as soon as reasonably possible following marking, moderation and approval of the results by the Assessment Board (approximately six to eight weeks after the date of the examination/assignment submission).

Students are notified by email when their marks are available in the CLTI Learning Hub. Results are never released over the telephone.

Grading

Score	Grade
70+	Distinction
60-69	Merit
50-59	Pass
Below 50	Fail

All certificates will be issued digitally through our credentials partner, Diplomasafe, within 4–6 weeks of your result date. Once you have completed the STEP Diploma, you will also receive an overall completion certificate digitally via Diplomasafe within the same 4–6 week timeframe.

The STEP Diploma can be awarded at Pass, Merit and Distinction level. To achieve a Merit overall, you must achieve an average of 60% or more across the four papers, and to achieve a Distinction overall you must achieve an average of 70% or more. If you are exempt from one or two of the Diploma papers, then you may be awarded a Merit if you achieve an average of 60% or more across the two/three papers taken, or a Distinction if you achieve an average of 70% or more across the two/three papers taken.

Examination Preparation

Preparing properly for your examination is a crucial component in doing yourself justice and succeeding in the examination. If you have followed your study plan, you will have highlighted the examination date, the date of any workshops and the schedule for completing the work on each of the course modules. The distance learning course, through the self-assessment material and module outcomes, encourages you to revise the material on a weekly basis.

You should also work through the specimen examination paper(s) and examiners' reports. Any points on which you are unclear can be clarified at the workshops or by contacting CLTI.

You should not stay up too late revising the night before the examination and should avoid last minute 'cramming' i.e. immediately prior to the exam.

Ensure that you read and understand the Examination Briefing Document as it contains important information and instructions regarding the format and submission arrangements for your examination. It is your obligation to make sure that you understand and comply with its contents.

At the start time of your examination, if you are already logged in to your course page, you may need to refresh your screen to view the examination paper. If you have any difficulty in accessing the paper, please contact cltinternational@centlaw.com as soon as possible.

Examination Approach

Where the examination question relates to a legal problem a good standard approach to use is as follows.

1. State the relevant principles of law accurately.
2. Apply these principles of law to the particular legal issues raised by the question set.
3. Use relevant authorities e.g. cases or statutes to support the argument in relation to the question set (see below).
4. Make informal and critical comment on the law.
5. Ask yourself the following questions:
 - Have I addressed all the issues?
 - Have I given all the necessary information?
 - Have I stated the law fully enough?
 - Have I applied the law to the facts of the problem in this question?
 - Have I dealt with all possible interpretations of the facts?

Examiner's instructions

Understanding the meaning of the key words used by the examiner in questions is crucial in helping you meet the examiner's criteria for passing the examination paper.

Some examples include:

Advise	Put forward information, opinions or recommendations to enable the person to take action.
Analyse	Examine in detail in order to discover its meaning or essential features.
Assess	Judge the worth or importance of a topic.
Compare (and)	Examine in order to observe resemblances or differences.
Contrast	Set in opposition to bring out differences.
Criticise	Give your views about the matter, backing your judgement with a discussion of the evidence.
Describe	Give an account of by identifying the important features or characteristics.
Discuss	Give the facts and their interpretation from all sides of the argument. Try to arrive at a conclusion.
Distinguish	Show the differences between or among.
Evaluate	Give your opinion of the worth of something in the light of its truth and usefulness.
Explain	Give a clear and detailed account of.
Illustrate	Clarify by the use of examples or comparisons.
Reconcile	Make two apparently conflicting views or decisions compatible or consistent with each other.
Summarise/Outline	Give a brief account of the main points of.
What is the significance of...?	Attempt a definition followed by an outline of uses, consequences and implications.

Use of language in examinations

An examiner will always be impressed by clear, coherent and well-written examination answers. General points that examiners look for are as follows:

- **Coherency**
 - Logical overall structure of the examination answer
 - Coherent sentence structure (including spelling, length)
 - Unambiguous meaning

- **Accuracy**

Attention should be paid to particular aspects of the language used, such as:

- tenses
- form of verbs
- use of plural/singular
- punctuation
- use of a/the

- **Appropriateness**

The appropriate form of language for an essay, assignment or problem is to strike a balance between not being formal and not being too informal. Avoid expressing your own views in terms such as 'I think that', but use expressions such as 'a better view' or 'it is suggested that'.

When asked to write a letter to a client as part of an answer to a question, ensure that appropriate language as well as format is used, as a formal letter is still an important form of communication.

Practices to avoid

The following is a list of common mistakes found in examination answers that should be avoided.

- Typing the question out, or repeating the question
- Long introductions
- Irrelevance or ambiguity
- Absence of authority, too much authority or irrelevant authority
- Telling too much of the story of the cases you use for authority
- Jumping to a conclusion
- No conclusion or inappropriate conclusion
- Illogical order, repeating information
- Incoherent /lack of paragraphs or sentences
- Inaccurate grammar – splitting infinitives; mixing singular and plural
- Inappropriate tone, use of slang or jargon
- Abbreviations without a full definition

Citation and referencing

All assessments are checked using plagiarism software that checks for text found in the STEP/CLTI course materials and elsewhere across billions of sources including Internet pages and student assessments. It also checks to see if it can detect use of artificial intelligence (AI) software. Our plagiarism software is extremely effective at identifying plagiarism and AI academic malpractice.

You should ensure that any content that is not in your own wording has been appropriately referenced, this includes any materials provided as part of the course, or examination papers you have previously submitted (self-plagiarism). Limited marks are awarded where answers are over-reliant on the course material, and you are expected to show application of your own knowledge.

Submissions that have a significant proportion of non-original content will be investigated through our Academic Malpractice procedures and could result in a mark of 0 being achieved or a deduction made to your result.

Cases and statute should be used to support any reasoning or facts given in answer to a question. They show you are 'well read' and there will be credit for quoting the right cases or statutes, but they do not replace setting out the basic tenets of the law. Do not give chapter and verse regarding the background of the parties to the action, places, times etc. but the name of the case, (preferably) with the year of the law report, any relevant facts and the outcome.

Always relate the outcome to the point in question. Quoting from a judge's dicta, whilst often interesting, even amusing, is not necessary. Do not quote the same case for every point in the hope that it will be right for one of the answers.

With statutes, make sure you have the up to date position, especially where there are later statutes that are passed from time to time amending existing statutes such as the Trustee Delegation Act 1999 amending Trustee Act 1925. With statutes, it is necessary to quote the section, statute name in full and the year of the Act, e.g. section 31 Trustee Act 1925.

You do not need to repeat the Act when referring to sections if it is clear from the context or by the use of standard abbreviations, e.g. IHTA 1984, LPA 1925 etc.

Latin terms

Only use Latin terms where there is no real alternative as they are a 'proper' name or they convey a special meaning, e.g. *donatio mortis causa*, *sui juris*.

Further reference:

- The rubric at the beginning of the specimen examination papers
- The examination briefing document